The Seven Sacraments

A set-collection card game — Ages 8-12 — 2-5 Players — 20-25 Minutes

Age Range	Players	Play Time	Difficulty
8-12	**2-5**	**20-25 minutes**	**Easy-Medium**

About This Game

The Seven Sacraments teaches children about the holy mysteries of the Coptic Orthodox Church. Players collect sets of five element cards, each representing a key component of one of the seven sacraments. Through play, children learn what makes each sacrament unique and why these sacred mysteries matter for the life of the Church.

> **Formation Goal:** Understanding the seven sacraments of the Coptic Orthodox Church — their elements, their meaning, and their place in the life of every believer.

Components

- **35 Element Cards** — 5 cards for each of the 7 sacraments, each showing one essential element
- **This rules sheet**

Setup

1. Print the card sheets on cardstock (110 lb recommended).
2. Cut along the card borders. You should have 35 cards total.
3. Shuffle all 35 cards together.
4. Deal 5 cards to each player.
5. Place the remaining cards face-down in a draw pile in the centre.
6. Turn the top card of the draw pile face-up to start the discard pile.

How to Play

1. The youngest player goes first. Play proceeds clockwise.
2. On your turn, do **one** of the following:
   - **Draw** the top card from the draw pile, OR
   - **Take** the top card from the discard pile (only if it matches a sacrament you are already collecting).
3. After drawing, you **must discard** one card from your hand face-up onto the discard pile.
4. If you ever hold all 5 element cards of a single sacrament, lay them face-up in front of you. This is a **completed sacrament**. Say the name of the sacrament aloud!
5. After completing a sacrament, draw back up to 5 cards from the draw pile (or as many as remain).
6. Play continues until the draw pile is empty and no more moves can be made, or until a player completes their second sacrament.

Winning

The first player to complete **two full sacraments** (10 cards, 5 per sacrament) wins the game. If the draw pile runs out before anyone completes two, the player with the most completed sacraments wins. If tied, the player with the most cards toward an incomplete sacrament wins.

Matching Guide

Each sacrament has exactly 5 element cards. Collect all 5 to complete it:

- **Baptism:** Water of the Jordan, Holy Oil (Ghaliloun), Three Immersions, Renunciation of Satan, White Garment
- **Chrismation:** Holy Myron, 36 Anointings, Seal of the Holy Spirit, Breath of the Priest, Girdle of Faith
- **Confession:** Repentant Heart, Absolution Prayer, The Epitrachelion, Examination of Conscience, Penance and Counsel
- **Eucharist:** The Lamb (Bread), The Wine, The Epiclesis, Body and Blood of Christ, The Fraction

- **Anointing of the Sick:** Oil of the Sick, Seven Prayers, Laying on of Hands, Anointing of the Senses, Prayer of Faith
- **Matrimony:** The Crowns, Rings of Betrothal, The Blessing Prayer, Unity of Flesh, Psalm of Joy
- **Priesthood:** Laying on of Hands, Breath of the Holy Spirit, The Vestments, Apostolic Succession, The Ordination Prayer

Tips for Parents and Teachers

- When a sacrament is completed, ask the child: "When does the Church give us this sacrament?" and "Have you received it?"
- For younger players (age 8), consider removing 2 sacraments (14 cards) to play with only 5 sacraments.
- Encourage children to read the descriptions on each card aloud as they play.
- After the game, discuss which sacraments the children have already received and which they will receive in the future.

Variants

- **Cooperative mode:** Work together to complete all 7 sacraments before the draw pile runs out. Share information about your hands and plan together.
- **Teaching mode:** Play with all cards face-up on the table. Take turns selecting cards to complete sacraments, discussing each element as it is chosen.
- **Quick game:** First player to complete **one** sacrament wins. Good for younger players or short sessions.
- **Expert mode:** Players must complete sacraments in the order they are received in life: Baptism, then Chrismation, then any others.

> *"Jesus answered, 'Most assuredly, I say to you, unless one is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God.'" — John 3:5*